

Building a painting

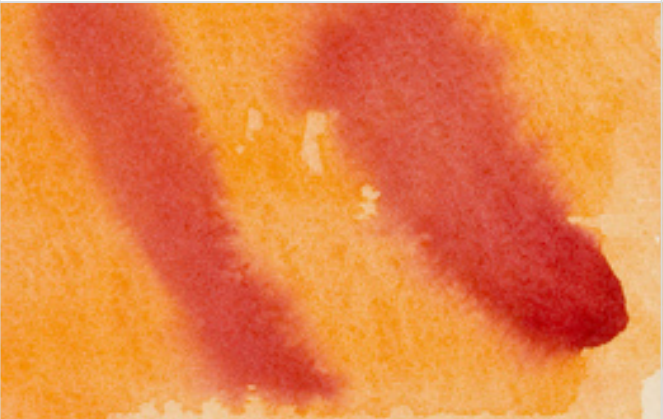
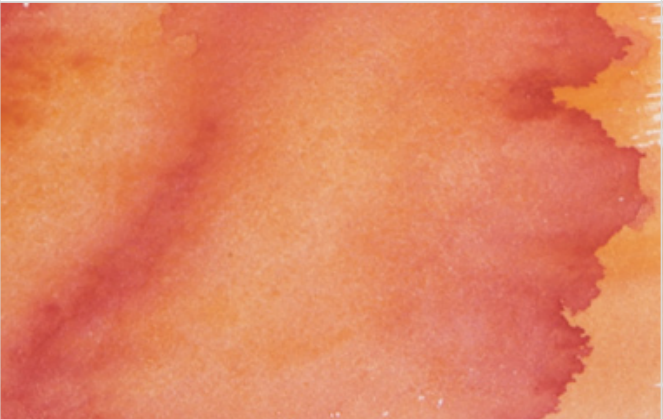
Watercolor paintings can be built up by adding layers of paint either to paint that has already dried—wet on dry—or to color that is still wet—wet-in-wet. Laying down paint wet on dry produces vivid colors with strong edges. You can paint wet on dry with a high

level of accuracy so it is a good technique to choose when painting detail. Wet-in-wet is more immediate and the results, produced as the colors blend, are softer and less predictable. Wet-in-wet is useful for backgrounds and the early stages of a painting.

WET OR DRY?

Try out these two techniques to see the effects they produce. Practicing will also help you to judge how wet or dry your paper is, which helps you to anticipate the effect your painting will

produce. If paint is added to a wash before it is completely dry, particularly on smooth paper, it may cause backruns as the second color runs into the first and dries in blotches with hard edges.

WET ON DRY  Paint cadmium orange onto dry paper. When the paint is completely dry, add strokes of cadmium red. The red paint retains the shape of the brushstrokes, with strong edges, but lets the orange show through.	WET-IN-WET  Wet the paper with a large brush and wait for the sheen to go off. Paint an orange mix on the paper, followed immediately by strokes of red. The red paint merges with the orange so its shape is far less defined.
BACKRUN WITH WATER  Paint a red wash and allow it to half dry. While the paper is still damp, add spots of water with the tip of a round brush. The water pushes the red paint out to create circles.	BACKRUN WITH PAINT  Paint an orange wash and allow to half dry. Drop in a watery mix of red. The red runs back into the orange to create cauliflowerlike shapes with hard edges and diluted centers that let the orange show through.